

Landscape

Paintings of the natural world have appeared in various cultures at different times, usually as backgrounds. However, Chinese *shan shui* ('mountain-water' or 'pure') landscape painting developed during the Liu Song Dynasty (420–479 CE). Before the 18th century, most Japanese artists followed the Chinese idea that idealized landscapes were the most appropriate subject for secular painting. Frescoes of imaginary panoramas were also painted in the ancient Roman cities of Pompeii and Herculaneum.

The 17th-century Dutch Golden Age inspired interest in landscape as a subject in itself, and by the 18th century, artists such as Canaletto, Guardi and Claude flourished. In England, an entire landscape movement developed, with painters including John Constable (1776–1837), J.M.W. Turner and Thomas Girtin (1775–1802) bringing new energy into the genre. Constable and Turner's innovative practice of painting in oils in the open air was taken up across Europe. Meanwhile in Germany, Caspar David Friedrich (1774–1840) created mysteriously illuminated, ethereal landscapes.



Constable, *Flatford Mill*, 1816–7